STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-8400
SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 04/01/08	DATE REVISED **03/22/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
	APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: RAPID DEPLOYMENT FORCE	RESOURCES		
SUBJECT CRITERIA FOR RDF ACTIVATION	CROSS REFERENCE AU-8300 RDF Training and Operations		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the activation of the Rapid Deployment Force.

II. Policy:

The Rapid Deployment Force (RDF) shall be available twenty-four (24) hours a day for emergency situations that may require the unit's response. Requests for immediate activation of the RDF for civil disturbances shall be made through the RDF Commander or Platoon Leader. Other requests for the activation of the RDF shall be made through the RDF Commander. If the RDF Commander is unavailable, requests shall be made through the RDF Platoon Leader.

The RDF is part of a larger metro area unit, the Rapid Deployment Force. The Rapid Deployment Force is made up of multiple area law enforcement agencies. Any law enforcement agency participating in the RDF may request a call out. The RDF will handle small scale disturbances or protests within the County. Should the need arise to deal with a large scale disturbance, the entire RDF may be requested. The RDF operates under the command of the requesting agency.

III. Procedure:

A. Activation Criteria: The following are examples of situations where RDF could be utilized. This list is not all-inclusive:

1. Large gatherings of people.
2. Demonstrations.
3. Jail disturbances.
4. Major confrontations involving civil disturbance, riot, protest, etc.
5. Natural disaster or civil defense emergency.

6. Coverage of special events where the equipment and skills of RDF may be rapidly deployed.
7. VIP/dignitary protection.

B. RDF **Activation-Civil Disturbance:** Generally, the RDF is utilized for pre-planned events, but any supervisor may request the RDF during a civil disturbance by contacting the RDF Commander or Platoon Leader. The RDF Commander (or the Platoon Leader) shall make an immediate determination regarding the need for RDF and shall have Communications notify the appropriate personnel. Supervisors and command officers should be aware that mobilization of the multi-jurisdictional Rapid Deployment Force may take several hours.

C. **RDF Activation-Pre-Planned Events:** Due to the potential for a civil disturbance, the RDF may be utilized during large gatherings of individuals especially when those gatherings may include opposing groups or potentially violent confrontations to lessen the potential danger to members of the Sheriff's Office and citizens. The following procedures shall be followed when a Sheriff's Office employee becomes aware of a large event that could result in a civil disturbance.

1. The employee becoming aware of the event shall notify and brief the RDF Commander. The RDF Commander shall determine the need for the RDF to be present at the event.

2. If the RDF Commander is unavailable, the employee shall notify the RDF Platoon Leader.

3. If it has been determined that the RDF will be present at the event, the RDF Commander shall complete all required preplanning including an Incident Action Plan (see AU-8300 RDF Training and Operations).

4. The RDF Commander shall notify the RDF members and provide a time and location for the briefing. Since many RDF members are not issued pagers, as much prior notice as possible should be provided.

D. **RDF Activation-Outside Agency:** Requests for the use of the **RDF** which come from sources outside the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall be directed to the **RDF** Commander.

1. The **RDF** Commander shall determine if the **RDF** shall respond to the request.

2. If the **RDF** Commander is unavailable, the **RDF** Platoon Leader shall make the determination.

3. Sheriff's Office personnel (e.g. **RDF** Commander, Platoon Leader, or Squad Leader) shall have the ultimate responsibility for making all decisions regarding the actions of **RDF** members.

4. The Sheriff or Chief Deputy shall authorize the use of the **RDF** to assist any outside agency prior to deployment.